

Set Operators

SET operators are mainly used to combine the same type of data from two or more tables. Although more than one select statement will then be present, only one result set is returned.

Rules on Set Operations:

- The result sets of all queries must have the same number of columns.
- In every result set the data type of each column must match the data type of its corresponding column in the first result set.
- In order to sort the result, an ORDER BY clause should be part of the last statement.
- The records from the top query must match the positional ordering of the records from the bottom query.
- The column names or aliases must be found out by the first select statement.

The four-set operators union, union all, intersect, and except allow us to serially combine two or more select statements.

Operator	Returns
UNION	Combine two or more result sets into a single set, without duplicates.
UNION ALL	Combine two or more result sets into a single set, including all duplicates.
INTERSECT	Takes the data from both result sets which are in common.
EXCEPT	Takes the data from the first result set, but not the second (i.e. no matching to each other)

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